

Who holds your attention?

CTIN 290 · Monday September 21 · 10 AM to 12:50 PM · SCI L104

What does the camera help you notice, and what does it keep you from choosing to watch?

Today's screenings

10:10: Critical Role, the cold open. Watch video 0:00 to 18:51, then annotate and discuss until 10:40. Keep one visible action or arrangement and a timestamp. Distinguish what is described aloud from what you can see.

11:05: the official Hamilton trailer. Three complete plays: with sound, muted, then calling the cuts. Compare what a wide view and a closer view let you inspect. The trailer does not establish what happens throughout the full production.

11:30: a second look at Critical Role, video 7:28 to 8:38. Use the longer opening as context. Name an action before inferring its meaning.

Three tools for the comparison

Blocking

Positions, paths, distance, and facing. Stillness can be a deliberate arrangement.

Gesturality

Bodily gestures create expressive meaning. A repeated gesture may become recognizable behavior; more than one example is needed to establish repetition.

Reaction shot

A view emphasizes someone's response. The bodily response is performance; choosing to show it is framing or editing.

I noticed _____. It might suggest _____. I would need _____ before being sure.

Full break: 10:55 to 11:05.

Viewing cues and timestamps

Your route through class

10:00 to 10:08 · Sound and action

10:08 to 10:10 · Who chooses the view?

10:10 to 10:40 · Critical Role: the cold open

10:40 to 10:55 · Three performance tools

10:55 to 11:05 · Ten-minute break

11:05 to 11:30 · Hamilton: one trailer, three views

11:30 to 11:38 · Critical Role: a second look

11:38 to 11:50 · A camera choice for a game

11:50 to 11:55 · One World, Two Media

11:55 to 12:15 · Evidence rehearsal and feedback

12:15 to 12:45 · Thirty minutes with your team

12:45 to 12:50 · One observation, one question

12:15 to 12:45 · Your team's board

Thirty uninterrupted minutes on your existing board for a game involving collaboration. Choose or revise references and explain why they belong. Keep your board somewhere everyone can access.

Final brief: 20 to 40 images establishing visual language, tone, color palette, and world. Five-minute presentation; everyone speaks.

Rubric: Visual Cohesion; Curation & Justification; Color & Palette Development; Presentation & Accessibility. Four criteria, five points each.

Dates to keep

Video essay: September 24, 5 PM Pacific. Mood-board file: October 1, 5 PM Pacific. Presentations: October 5. Today adds no new submission.

[Mood-board studio and presentation examples](#)

[Digital notes](#)

[Video-essay assignment and rubric](#)